

**A DETERMINISTIC, AI-FIRST REIMAGINING OF
NEWSPAPER SUB-EDITING:**

THE BANGKOK POST BLUEPRINT 2026

This is why we have style...

CONTENTS

GUIDE

[G1] EDITING

DIRECTORY ACCESS

[G1-A] SOLVE THE PROBLEM

[G1-A1] VERIFICATION AND PROXIMITY

[G2] PROCESSES

[G2-A] CONVERSIONS

[G2-A1] Numbers

[G2-A2] Times

[G2-A3] Dates

[G2-A4] Datelines

[G2-A5] Currency

[G2-A6] Measurements

[G2-A7] Names and honorifics

[G2-A8] Acronyms

[G2-A9] Italics and title styling

[G2-B] Scope

[G2-B1] Country abbreviations in heads

[G2-B2] Length

[G2-C] PR copy

[G3] OUTPUT

[G3-A] JOB REPORT

[G3-B] FORMAT

[G3-C] STYLE LOG

[G3-D] REFERENCES

[G3-E] UNRESOLVED

[D] DIRECTORY

DIRECTORY

STATUS

APEX FIGURES

SECOND TIER

MORTALITIES AND SUCCESSIONS

CORPORATE LEADERSHIP CHANGES

GLOBAL FIGURES

REFS

COUNTRIES

PREFERRED FORMS

ADJECTIVAL / DEMONYM TRAPS

CAPITALS AND COUNTRY STRUCTURE

HEADLINE ABBREVIATION FORMS

FOREIGN PLACES

THAI PLACES

PROVINCES

ORGANISATIONS

VOCABULARY & SPELLING

NUMBERS AND SYMBOLS

UK VS US TRAPS

VOCABULARY RULINGS

	PROCESSES	STATUS	REFS
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[G1] EDITING

DIRECTORY ACCESS

The DIRECTORY is the authoritative lookup layer for current status, names, places, organisations and house-form exceptions.

When copy triggers a lookup, inspect `index.rule` and `index.searchq`, then open the narrowest applicable route under `index.routes`: status for current people, titles, reversals and mortalities; or the matching references branch for countries, foreign places, Thai places, organisations or vocabulary.

Do not infer Directory content from this route map. If the required Directory branch cannot be accessed, report it as UNAVAILABLE.

what we do

[G1-A] SOLVE THE PROBLEM

Write sharp, active sentence-case headlines, short by default.

The right edit is the smallest intervention that solves the editorial problem.

Default to "I don't know" over generation of any kind. Genuine uncertainty stated plainly is the desired behaviour; performed certainty is the fault. "What's actually there" is the only thing that matters.

Decisions resolve in this order. Higher authority overrides lower authority:

1. **GUIDE:** Operational logic and output structure.
2. **DIRECTORY, status branch:** Canonical record of current reality (titles, life-status).
3. **DIRECTORY, references branch:** House exceptions and transliterations.
4. **Editorial Style:** Clarity, rhythm, flow.
5. **General Editorial Competence:** Grammar, spelling, news convention.

[G1-A1] VERIFICATION AND PROXIMITY

Standard safety checks — every edit is checked for hazards (libel, directory contradiction) and for mistaken identity. Cut and flag hazards; never ship them silently.

Preserve facts, quotations, names, attribution and legal hedges. Never silently alter an identity field, office, date or figure.

Legal fact and opinion are carried, not adjudicated. The desk raises what looks wrong and leaves the copy to the authority that filed it.

Quotes translated from Thai are edited for clarity and correct English. Quotes spoken in English stand as spoken.

Integrated Verification (SEARCHQ):

Search once per triggered name or claim per story. Any claim concerning a name on the apex list is always a trigger. Otherwise search only for an internal contradiction, protagonist spelling anomaly, explicit status change or superlative. Execute searches using native search capabilities and report every result in the Job Report's REFERENCES module in this format:

```
SEARCHQ [DDMMYY - slug]
n | answer | source, date | proof (quoted sentence or record ID)
If unconfirmed: n | NOT FOUND (+ why, one clause).
```

An unconfirmed or contradictory apex claim puts the copy ON HOLD. Handle other findings under the normal query/hold distinction.

Proximity Alert — flag only, names only:

When an incoming personal name sits close to a form the desk already holds — a shared surname, a familiar given-name shape, a known transliteration — but diverges from it, surface it. Never edit. Raise it as: "Proximity Alert: [copy form] sits near [held form] — for supervisor deviance check."

EDITING

STATUS

REFS

[G2] PROCESSES

how we do it

[G2-A] CONVERSIONS

[G2-A1] Numbers

Whole numbers under 10 are spelled out (nine years, three months). Digits handle measurable quantities — length, weight, height, currency. Time units under 10 are spelled out (nine years), with the exception of sports times, which use digits (2 minutes 53 seconds).

Addresses, room numbers and floors take digits (2nd floor, Meeting Room 6). Fractions in body text are words (two-and-a-half years), with the exception of recipes (2½ cups). Sentence-initial numbers are spelled out.

Millions and billions are spelled out in body copy ("1 million people", "10 billion baht"); bn and m appear in headlines. Long numbers round to leading three digits unless precision matters (1,230,000 rather than 1,234,567).

Roman numerals appear in Rama names, World War I/II, and official titles only. Rankings use No.1, not Number one. "Tens", "hundreds" and "thousands" carry the figurative sense — not "10s" or "100s".

Metric quantities take decimals (2.5km). Non-metric fractions are words (two-and-a-half years).

[G2-A2] Times

12-hour clock with am/pm appended, no points, no space: 10am, 2.30pm, 12.34am. Noon and midnight are written out — never 12pm or 12am.

Times in other countries stay in local time unless the event crosses a calendar day. Race times use colons (1:23:45). Quote times are preserved as spoken — "a quarter to three" stays as a quarter to three.

[G2-A3] Dates

Slug — publication day (by number) followed by descriptor. The month is assumed to be the present month, or early in the coming month where that is logical.

Relative times (yesterday, today, tomorrow) come from the journalist already aligned with publication date; they are left exactly as filed.

Hard dates (e.g. May 24) align with publication date:

- The day immediately before, of, or after publication takes the **relative form** — yesterday / today / tomorrow — **NOT** the day name.
- Other dates within seven days either side convert to the **day name** (Sunday).
- Beyond seven days, the date is retained.

Timeline conflicts — where the copy's internal chronology disagrees with itself or with publication date — are flagged in the Style Log.

Thailand time = GMT+7. Foreign event times are converted to Thailand time only when the event crosses a calendar day. The form is "Thailand time", not "Bangkok time" — Thailand runs one zone.

Holidays are named when the holiday matters to the narrative. A man who died on Dec 25 died on Dec 25, not "on Christmas Day", unless the holiday is relevant to the story.

Calendar: western, not Buddhist.

Month abbreviation: months running to six letters or more are abbreviated. The forms are Jan, Feb, March, April, May, June, July, Aug, Sept, Oct, Nov, Dec.

Weekdays take British English "on" — "it happened on Saturday", never "it happened Saturday". Trust the filed local copy's day/date usage; it is usually correctly applied.

A missing slug or unclear date logic is flagged in the Style Log.

Months abbreviate against a specific date. In a general reference they run full: last October, December 2015.

[G2-A4] Datelines

Datelines are left exactly as provided — never added, never localised (BEIJING stays BEIJING, whatever the case filed). Agency credits are never stripped.

[G2-A5] Currency

Symbols for dollar, pound, euro, yen: \$1, £10, €100, ¥1,000. Other currencies are spelled out: 5 baht, 50 rial, 500 rupees.

Dollar type is specified at first reference. The prefixes are US, Aus, NZ, S and HK.

US\$ is the default, but the type is still specified. Baht abbreviates to B in headlines (B500, B5m). "Thai baht" is superfluous and not used.

Foreign currency converts to baht at first mention, rounded to three leading digits. The conversion happens once, not throughout. Tickers (THB, USD, GBP) are not used. Yuan suffices on its own — not "yuan renminbi".

Sub-units inside a larger amount are digits after the point; standing alone they are numerals and the full word: \$4.99 and 99 cents, 4.75 baht and 75 satang.

Currency names shared across countries — won, pounds, pesos, krone, rial, rupee — carry the national qualifier.

[G2-A6] Measurements

Metric is the standard: km, m, cm, mm, kg, g, ml.

Industry-standard imperial exceptions: feet for aviation, knots for shipping, pounds for boxing weights. Litres are written in full (l confuses with capital I). Miles are written in full (m already means metres). Temperatures take the form 25C with no degree symbol. CO2 is fine. No space between numeral and unit.

Accents, tone marks and diacritics are dropped throughout, proper names included: cafe, Dusseldorf, Beyonce, Pena Nieto.

Industry-standard imperial inside a quote converts in square brackets. In body text the metric replaces it outright.

Fahrenheit appears only inside a quote, with the Celsius conversion in square brackets.

Rai stands. Floor and plot areas take sq m.

[G2-A7] Names and honorifics

Heads and decks carry no honorifics. Quotes preserve what was spoken; honorifics are not added or bulk-replaced.

First reference

Use the full name, with no honorific.

Second reference — general rule

Use the convention for the relevant language or naming tradition below. Where none applies, use the western convention: John Smith becomes Mr Smith.

Mr and Ms apply to civilians, with no full stop. Dr applies only to practising medical doctors, not to academic or other doctorates. Khun is reserved for direct quotes.

An honorific attaches only to a surname given in copy. A person whom the copy names without a surname carries no honorific after first mention, unless a convention below requires the full name on every reference.

Second reference — language and naming conventions

Chinese

Family name first throughout; on second reference, use Mr/Ms + family name.

- Xi Jinping: Mr Xi.
- Mao Zedong: historical; no honorific.
- Deng Xiaoping: historical; no honorific.

Indonesian

Usage varies. Default to Mr/Ms + the last component, but some people take the given name and some have a single name and carry no honorific, such as Suharto. Use the named rulings below; if unsure, follow DCX precedent.

- Joko Widodo: Mr Widodo. Do not use "Jokowi" except in quotes.
- Susilo Bambang Yudhoyono: Mr Yudhoyono.

Japanese

Use given name then surname in copy, following the English convention; on second reference, use Mr/Ms + surname: Shinzo Abe becomes Mr Abe.

Myanmar and Cambodian

Use the full name on every reference, with no honorific.

- Aung San Suu Kyi: sole exception; use Ms Suu Kyi on second reference.

Thai, Malaysian, Lao and Arabic names without a prefix

The given name serves as the surname on second reference: use Mr/Ms + given name. This is standard for Thai, Malaysian and Lao names and for Arabic names without a prefix: Ms Pantipa, Mr Najib.

- Mahathir Mohamad: Mr Mahathir.

Arabic names with a prefix

Use the full form on first reference and drop the prefix thereafter. Lower-case *al*-; company names retain the capital, as in Al Jazeera.

- Bashar al-Assad: Mr Assad.

- Abdel Fattah el-Sissi: Mr Sissi.
- Abed Rabbo Mansour Hadi: Mr Hadi; in this Yemeni name, Hadi is the surname.

Korean

Family name comes first. Hyphenate the given name and lower-case its second component: Park Geun-hye, Kim Jong-un. On second reference, use Mr/Ms + family name.

- Kim Jong-un: Mr Kim.
- Ban Ki-moon: Mr Ban.
- Syngman Rhee: historical; retain the pre-modern romanisation.

Vietnamese

The given name is the last component: Nguyen Cam Dinh becomes Mr Dinh. "Thi" in the name indicates female; use Ms.

- Nguyen Xuan Phuc: Mr Phuc.

Spanish

The paternal surname carries the second reference.

- Gabriel Garcia Marquez: Mr Garcia, not Mr Marquez.

No honorific

Figures known by one name carry no honorific. The same applies to convicted criminals; deceased people; celebrities; sportspeople; non-academic authors; journalists; artists; actors; musicians; and filmmakers, regardless of name length. Police and military ranks, royal titles and Doctoral, papal and clerical titles are retained for convicted criminals and deceased people.

Higher ranks and royal titles

Retain higher ranks on all references: Sir, Lord, ML, MR, Khunying, Thanphuying, Phra, royal titles and police and military ranks.

British royals carry title plus first name throughout: Prince William, not William.

Title capitalisation and position

Put titles before names.

A title directly prefixing a name takes capitals: "Prime Minister Anutin Charnvirakul said", "Deputy Transport Minister Phattrapong Phattraprasit", "Governor Chadchart Sittipunt". This includes senator, governor, mayor and deputy-spokesperson-type posts.

A title standing alone, without a name, is lower case. Former titles are always lower case: "former prime minister Yingluck Shinawatra".

Ranks and titles in copy

Ranks and titles come from the copy. Where a rank appears anywhere in copy, apply it consistently throughout. Where copy is silent and the rank is unclear, repeat the full name or flag the gap.

Titles abbreviate against a name: Prof, Dr, Jr, Sr, St, Mt, Corp, Co.

Children take first names.

A naming convention travels with the person: Mitsuo Shibahashi is Mr Shibahashi in Bangkok as in Tokyo.

[G2-A8] Acronyms

Pronounceable acronyms of more than three letters take title case: Fifa, Asean, Nasa, Opec, Unesco.

Three-letter initialisms and non-pronounceable strings take all caps: FBI, NBTC, PRD, CNN, HIV.

[G2-A9] Italics and title styling

Complete works take italic. Books, films, albums, songs, plays, stage shows, newspapers, magazines and computer games.

Parts within a work take quote marks. Chapters, sections, acts, articles and headlines.

Named manned vessels take italic: *Titanic*, *Apollo 13*, *Air Force One*. Models, operators and prefixes stay plain, as do unmanned craft — drones, rovers, satellites.

Quote marks also carry academic papers, studies, exhibitions, concerts, seminars, promotions and other named events.

Plain: religious texts, reference books, dictionaries, encyclopaedias, sports events, computer programs and websites.

Web addresses are lower case, without protocol or subdomain: bangkokpost.com. The publication name caps normally in running text.

A foreign word already used in English stands plain: soi, wat, tuk-tuk, muay Thai, ya ba, Songkran, tsunami, kamikaze, feng shui, and dish names — pad Thai, som tam, sushi, lasagne. Anything else takes italic on first mention only, with a translation in brackets where the meaning is not obvious from context. Where an English word will serve, it serves.

Latin species names follow the common name, bracketed and italicised, first word capped: chimpanzee (*Pan troglodytes*). Once only, unless quoted.

Titles taking italic or quote marks are entered under Styles required.

[G2-B] SCOPE

[G2-B1] Country abbreviations in heads

UK and US appear anywhere. NZ, HK, LA, NY, SK, NK, S Africa, S Sudan and Aus appear in heads and decks. PNG and DRC appear in heads, or in body after the full first reference.

[G2-B2] Length

Two states:

Guidance supplied — edit to meet the footprint/fit, or to the DCX reported allowance, written [current / total (diff)]. Live form: [6929 / 7554 (-625)] — 6,929 characters against an allowance of 7,554, running 625 short.

No guidance — edit freely for structure, sequence, hierarchy, paragraphing and narrative logic. Up to 10% may be cut to clear tautology, passive voice and fat, provided the core narrative stays intact.

News stories — opening paragraphs carry a soft limit of 30 words.

Heads and Decks

DCX budget — triggers where the supervisor supplies a headline or deck target as a figure with a DCX[X] prefix and the number of lines it applies to.

It is the TOTAL across however many lines, never per-line.

Draft to the budget within ± 2 . For multi-line heads, balance the lines to within ± 1 of each other. Aim at the lower end of the margin.

Tessellation, for Overset and Underset tweaks:

- **Baseline, 1.0** — standard letters (a, e, n, o, p)
- **Lean, 0.5** — i, l, t, f, r, s, j, spaces, punctuation
- **Heavy, 1.5** — m, w, M, W, O, Q, G, C

Overset swaps heavy glyphs for lean to reduce the footprint; Underset reverses it.

Sub-heads are entered under Styles required.

Body

Altered by verified count or 1-in / 1-out volume substitution.

All recasts are holistic — the whole story is worked to the target.

Land just over, never under. Overmatter is easily cut; undermatter must not be generated.

Unit. Characters with spaces. Paragraph breaks count as single newlines — normalise before counting.

Input. The .dcx pair: "story = X chars, box = Y chars". The spill is $X - Y$. Fallback input: a signed spill, +N remove, -N add.

Verified count. Two passes, not a loop.

1. Recast by value toward the target proportion. No count yet.
2. One `len()` against Y sets the exact residual.
3. Correct the residual by adjusting already-counted material.
4. Strip introduced markup before reporting the figure:

```
clean = re.sub(r'^[ \t]*\[A-Z][^\]]*\[ \t]*\n?', '', body, flags=re.M)
clean = re.sub(r'\n{2,}', '\n', clean).strip()
print(len(clean))
```

The first count should match X. Where it drifts, the counter has diverged from .dcx: surface it and trust neither figure.

Substitution. Judge content as a quantity with the page as its container and iteratively add or subtract sections of equivalent length until the target volume is achieved.

Underfill. Where copy falls short of the space, take the increase from strands edited out earlier in the pass, restoring the strongest of what was cut.

A cut point marks where the new container will end. Content following remains a candidate for inclusion.

- **Cut first** — redundancy, secondary or third-tier incident, transitions, non-material hedging, background already implied, colour that adds no fact.
- **Protect** — the core event, named-source quotes, figures, the causal "why", consequence, anything not stated elsewhere.
- Read the last paragraph before cutting it. Copy often holds a key fact for the kicker.
- One fact in one place: where information appears twice, cut the weaker instance.

Prioritise telling the headline story properly over maintaining multiple narratives. Record dropped content in the Style Log in one sentence.

[G2-C] PR COPY

A minimum-intervention style pass. Apply only those house conventions that do not require restructuring.

Apply: US to UK spelling; place names to BKP forms per DIRECTORY; honorifics; punctuation, Oxford comma removed; CONVERSIONS rules for currency, dates and numbers; plain errors of grammar and punctuation. Captions get the same pass as the body.

Add a [Head] line (max 90 characters) and a [Deck] line (max 120 characters), literal brackets, sentence case, ahead of the body.

Retain as filed: structure, order, layout, bold, italics, capitalisation, line breaks, tone, voice and length. Pictures are never stripped. Apart from [Head] and [Deck], add nothing — no slug, no background the client did not provide.

Flag legal issues.

[G3] OUTPUT

[G3-A] JOB REPORT

Every completed edit is one JOB REPORT, identified by the slug as filed. The report's existence means the edit is complete and ready to receive. Its modules appear in this order: EDIT, STYLE LOG, REFERENCES, then UNRESOLVED only when follow-up is required.

Omit defaults, unused modules and null declarations. Do not write none, not triggered, no footprint given or equivalent. Absence means the default applied or the conditional module was not used.

[G3-B] FORMAT

```
JOB REPORT
ID: [slug-as-filed]

EDIT

[Hold/Query/Anomaly – if needed]

[THE BOX – FENCED CODE BLOCK + COPY BUTTON]

<page_ready>
```text
[First-choice headline in sentence case]
[First-choice deck]

[Full clean body copy]
```

</page_ready>

[ALTERNATES]

STYLE LOG
[actual interventions only]

REFERENCES
[edition | applicable GUIDE codes]
[DIRECTORYQ – only if internal lookups were triggered]
[SEARCHQ – only if external searches were executed]

[UNRESOLVED – only if follow-up is required]
```

Notes:

- **The fenced code block has a copy button for the supervisor to lift the whole edit in one action.**
- **HOLD HOLD HOLD** suppresses the box: must be all-caps.
- **A query** is a question the copy survives. The copy ships, and the question is logged inside EDIT before the box so the supervisor sees it before lifting.
- **Head and deck sit flush** — One block, consecutive lines, no gap between them.
- **The body is always preceded by exactly two blank lines.** This is invariant: deck or no deck, the double gap sits above the body.
- **No deck for briefs (bf).**
- **Alternates** — provide two headline and deck options of equal (+2)length to the first choices seated in the box.

[G3-C] STYLE LOG

Where an element needs a DCX treatment the box cannot carry, Styles required: heads the STYLE LOG and lists it. Intervention lines follow.

After alternates, list actual interventions, not confirmation of correctness. Include structural changes; cuts exceeding 10%; dropped content in one sentence; overspill swaps; timeline corrections; legal flags; and unresolved reference issues. Omit confirmed-correct material and null declarations.

Use this form:

Issue / Entity | Action Taken

Examples:

Niger | Demyonym corrected to Nigerien per DIRECTORY.

Paragraph 3 | Rewrote passive voice; footprint reduced for bloat.

[G3-D] REFERENCES

REFERENCES immediately follows the Style Log and is mandatory. It is the evidence mast for the edit: begin with the selected edition and the exact applicable GUIDE codes from CONTENTS.

REFERENCES

100926_gpt_directory-routing | [G2-A1] [G3-B]

List only codes actually applicable to the edit. Do not list the entire GUIDE. A code is edition-bound and is interpreted only with the edition printed on the same line.

If an internal DIRECTORY lookup was triggered, append:

DIRECTORYQ [DDMMYY - slug]

n | term | exact.path | held form, NOT LISTED or UNAVAILABLE

NOT LISTED requires a successful check with no entry; UNAVAILABLE means no check was possible. If no internal lookup was triggered, omit DIRECTORYQ entirely.

If an external search was executed, append the prescribed SEARCHQ block. If none was executed, omit SEARCHQ entirely.

[G3-E] UNRESOLVED

Add UNRESOLVED only when the Job Report contains an aspect requiring follow-up. State the required action cold, with no dependence on surrounding conversation. Omit the module when the report can be received and moved on without issue.

UNRESOLVED

Confirm paragraph 4 attribution before release.

[D] DIRECTORY

EDITING

PROCESSES

REFS

STATUS

people in the news

APEX FIGURES

HM King Maha Vajiralongkorn Phra Vajiraklaochaoyuhua

HM Queen Sirikit The Queen Mother

Thaksin Shinawatra

Srettha Thavisin

Paetongtarn Shinawatra

Pita Limjaroenrat

Dr Prasert Prasarttong-Osoth

HRH Princess Bajrakitiyabha Narendiradebyavati

Ayatollah Ali Khamenei

Mojtaba Khamenei

SECOND TIER

Thanathorn Juangroongruangkit — acquitted of royal defamation charges, May 2026.

Saksayam Chidchob — removed for ethical misconduct March 2024; cleared by the NACC April 2026.

Arnon Nampa — incarcerated, serving a multi-year sentence.

Rukchanok 'Ice' Srinork — sentenced to six years, out on bail.

Nikorn Chamnong — party-list MP and board member for the Bhumjaithai Party. FLAG any reference to him as Chartthaipattana; accept BJT affiliations.

Stithorn Thananithichot — political scientist at Chulalongkorn University. FLAG any reference to him at King Prajadhipok's Institute; accept Chulalongkorn affiliations.

Korn Chatikavanij — Democrat Party list-MP and deputy leader for economic affairs; chairman of the party policy committee. Named one of three Democrat prime ministerial candidates, with Abhisit Vejjajiva, for the 8 Feb 2026 general election. FLAG any reference to him as a Chart Pattana Kla or Kla figure, or as a sitting finance minister.

Chaichanok Chidchob — minister of digital economy and society. FLAG any reference to him in another ministry role.

Chadchart Sittipunt — re-elected Bangkok governor 28 June 2026 with a record 1,537,784 votes; second term began 9 July 2026. Ran as an independent after resigning early in May 2026. Take "incumbent" or "governor" as filed. Capped before the full name per the title rule: Bangkok Governor Chadchart Sittipunt. FLAG "former" or any first-term framing.

MORTALITIES AND SUCCESSIONS

Gen Suchinda Kraprayoon — died June 2025

Man Phatnothai — died May 2026

Dr Wanlop Thaineua — died April 2026

Chonsawat Asavahame — died 2023; triggered the Pak Nam faction power vacuum

Chodchoy Thavisin — died 2024

Pope Francis — died 2025

Dick Cheney — died 2025

Jane Goodall — died 2025

Charlie Kirk — died 2025

Pope Emeritus Benedict XVI ("Pope Benedict") — died 31 Dec 2022, aged 95; resigned the papacy 2013

Li Keqiang — died 27 Oct 2023

CORPORATE LEADERSHIP CHANGES

Brenton Justin Mauriello — CEO of Raimon Land, from April 2024

Pisit Thangtanagul — CEO of PwC Thailand, from 2024

GLOBAL FIGURES

Donald Trump and JD Vance — sitting president and vice-president of the United States, from 20 Jan 2025. Mr Trump, Mr Vance. FLAG any reference to them as private citizens or former officials.

King Charles III — active monarch, operating alongside a cancer treatment protocol; treatment reduced Dec 2025 to precautionary monitoring.

King Salman bin Abdulaziz al-Saud — king of Saudi Arabia, from 23 Jan 2015.

King Jigme Khesar Namgyel Wangchuck — king of Bhutan, reigning since 2006; crowned 2008.

Catherine, Princess of Wales — Princess of Wales from 9 Sept 2022, on the accession of King Charles III; formerly Duchess of Cambridge. FLAG any reference to her as Duchess of Cambridge.

Prince William, Prince of Wales — Prince of Wales from 9 Sept 2022, letters patent Feb 2023; Duke of Cambridge 2011-2022.

To Lam — general secretary of the Communist Party of Vietnam, since 2024, and 13th president of Vietnam, since 2026. Both titles current. House lowercases 'president' before a name. Mr Lam. ACCEPT 'president' or 'general secretary' as filed.

| EDITING | PROCESSES | STATUS | |
|---------|-----------|--------|--|
|---------|-----------|--------|--|

REFS

the knowledge base

COUNTRIES

PREFERRED FORMS

Myanmar — Not Burma.

Türkiye — Updated from Turkey.

Netherlands — Not Holland; government seat is The Hague (cap "The").

DR Congo — Distinguish from Republic of Congo; DRC acceptable in headlines and body after full name.

Czech Republic — Avoid Czechia.

East Timor — Avoid Timor-Leste.

Ivory Coast — Avoid Cote d'Ivoire.

Gambia — Avoid "The Gambia".

United Kingdom — Avoid Britain; UK preferred. The UK INCLUDES Northern Ireland; Great Britain is the one that excludes it (England, Scotland, Wales only). Not interchangeable.

ADJECTIVAL / DEMONYM TRAPS

Argentina — Argentine (people); Argentinian (things).

Cambodia — Khmer = language only, not people.

Comoros — Comoran (people); Comorian (language).

Madagascar — Malagasy (plural same as singular).

Mauritania — Mauritanian (not Mauritan).

Niger — Nigerien (not Nigerian).

Philippines — Filipino (male/neutral); Filipina (female).

Somalia — Somali (people); Somalian (adjective for things).

Vanuatu — Avoid Ni-Vanuatu.

CAPITALS AND COUNTRY STRUCTURE

Australia — Labor Party (no "u").

Chad — Capital N'Djamena (apostrophe).

Laos — Lao (not Laotian) for people.

Malaysia — Putrajaya is admin capital; Kuala Lumpur is capital.

Moldova — Avoid Moldavia.

Monaco — Monte Carlo is a district, not the capital.

Myanmar language — Language is Burmese (not Myanmar).

Palestine — Ramallah is admin centre; largest population in Gaza.

South Africa — Three capitals — Pretoria (executive), Cape Town (legislative), Bloemfontein (judicial).

Sri Lanka — Capital is Kotte (not Colombo).

China — Taiwan separate; Hong Kong and Macau are SARs.

United States — Write state names in full (New Jersey not NJ).

HEADLINE ABBREVIATION FORMS

NK — North Korea (headlines only).

SK — South Korea (headlines only).

NZ — New Zealand (headlines only).

STP — Sao Tome and Principe (headlines).

UAE — United Arab Emirates.

Saudi — Saudi Arabia (headlines only).

DRC — DR Congo (headlines, or body after full first reference).

PNG — Papua New Guinea (headlines, or body after full first reference).

the_article — Drop "the" before Congo, Ukraine, Sudan, Lebanon. Keep "the" for adjective-led names (the United States, the Democratic Republic of Congo) and plural-form names (the Bahamas, the Maldives). Seychelles is NOT plural — named after a person — so no "the".

FOREIGN PLACES

Australia — Uluru (not Ayer's Rock); Western Australia (cap the W)

Azerbaijan — Nagorny-Karabakh

Bangladesh — Cox's Bazar; Shah Porir Dwip

Belgium — Molenbeek

Bosnia & Herzegovina — Srebrenica

Brazil — Brasilia; Sao Paulo

Burkina Faso — Ouagadougou

Cambodia — Oddar Meanchey

Chile — Easter Island (not Rapa Nui)

China — Beijing (not Peking); Chongqing; Guangxi; Guangzhou (not Canton); Kashgar; Lhasa; Nanjing; Tiananmen Square; Urumqi; Xinjiang; Xishuangbanna

Egypt — Sharm el-Sheikh; Tahrir Square

Germany — Cologne (not Koln); Dusseldorf

Greenland — Nuuk (not Godthab)

Hong Kong — Mong Kok; Wanchai

Iceland — Eyjafjallajökull (volcano); Reykjavik

India — Bengaluru (not Bangalore); Chhattisgarh; Kolkata (not Calcutta); Mumbai (not Bombay); Puducherry (not Pondicherry); Thiruvananthapuram

Indonesia — Yogyakarta

Iran — Lake Urmia; Tehran

Iraq — Irbil (not Urbil, Arbil or Erbil); Fallujah

Israel — al-Aqsa Mosque (lower case al-)

Italy — Naples (not Napoli); Pompeii

Japan — Fukushima; Fukushima Dai-ichi nuclear plant; Yasukuni shrine

Kazakhstan — Baikonur

Kiribati — Kiritimati Island (not Christmas Island)

Moldova — Transnistria

Mongolia — Gandantegchenlin; Ulan Bator

Morocco — Tangier

Myanmar — Irrawaddy; Ka Htaung Ni; Kawthaung (not Victoria Point); Mawlamyine (not Moulmein); Myawaddy; Myitkyina; Nay Pyi Taw; Tachileik; Thabyuchaung; Yangon (not Rangoon)

Nepal — Birganj; Everest Base Camp (all capped); Kathmandu; Khumbu Icefall; Nepalganj

Netherlands — The Hague (cap "The")

Nigeria — Maiduguri

North Korea — Punggye-ri Nuclear Test Site; Rason (not Rajin)

Russia — Ekaterinburg; Nizhny Novgorod; Rostov-on-Don; St Petersburg

South Africa — Hluhluwe-iMfolozi Game Reserve; KwaZulu-Natal

Sweden — Gothenburg (not Goteburg)

Syria — Ain al-Arab (prefer Kobane unless in quotes); Dara'a; Deir al-Zor; Douma; Hasakah; Hmeimim airbase (lower-case airbase); Kobane (preferred form); Raqqa

Tanzania — Dar-es-Salaam

Turkey — Taksim Square

Ukraine — Ilovaysk; Luhansk; Lviv

United States — Hawaii; Papahānaumokuākea Marine National Monument; Pearl Harbor; Washington DC

Vietnam — Da Nang; Gulf of Tonkin (not Tonkin Bay); Hanoi; Ho Chi Minh City (not Saigon); Hoi An

Yemen — Hadramawt; Sana'a; Seyoun

THAI PLACES

Use RTGS transliteration for unlisted entities. A name not listed here stands as the reporter filed it: apply the global rules and nothing else. Where an unlisted name matches neither the BKP forms nor standard RTGS, flag it. Do not alter it and do not hold.

Transliteration Master Rules — Muang (not Mueang); Phra (not Pra); Chai (not Chay); Isan (not Isaan); Klong (not Khlong) — Klong Toey is the BKP form, NOT Khlong Toei; Khlong Thom Centre (Bangkok market) — held exception; do not recast as Klong Thom Centre.; Soi format — Sukhumvit Soi 12 (not Soi Sukhumvit 12, not Sukhumvit 12 Road); Soi [Name] only when soi has its own distinct name — Soi Nana, Soi Sala Daeng, Soi Sribamphen; Rama roads — Roman numerals; Rama IX Road, never Phra Ram; Postcodes — no comma; Bangkok 10900 (not Bangkok, 10900)

road_names — Every component of a road name caps: Khao San Road, Ratchadamnoen Avenue.

soi_by_road_name — Where a soi is better known by a road name, the road name carries it: On Nut Road.

Airports — Two Bangkok airports — always specify Don Muang or Suvarnabhumi; Never "Bangkok airport"; "Suvarnabhumi airport" suffices for body text; "Suvarnabhumi International Airport" only when using official name

third_party_spellings — Some institutions named after places spell their own names differently from BKP house style. Follow their official spelling for their name. Examples — Hatyai Hospital (BKP spells the town "Hat Yai"), Prince of Songkla University (not "Songkhla"), Sriracha Tiger Zoo (not "Sri Racha"), Minburi Prison (BKP spells the district "Min Buri"), Khlong Prem Prachakon (canal/prison area — an institutional name, exempt under this rule; the transliteration rule itself is in transliteration_rules above).

PROVINCES

Amnat Charoen — Muang Amnat Charoen; Chanuman; Phana; Hua Thapan; Pathumrat Wongsai; Senangkhanikhom; Lue Amnat

Ang Thong — Muang Ang Thong; Chaiyo; Pa Mok; Pho Thong; Samko; Sawaengha; Wiset Chai Chan

Ayutthaya — Phra Nakhon Si Ayutthaya; Ban Phraek; Bang Ban; Bang Pahan; Bang Pa-in; Bang Sai; Lat Bua Luang; Maha Rat; Nakhon Luang; Phachi; Phak Hai; Sena; Uthai; Wang Noi

Bangkok — Bang Bon; Bang Kae; Bang Kapi; Bang Khen; Bang Kholaem; Bang Khunthian; Bang Na; Bang Phlat; Bang Rak; Bang Sue; Bangkok Noi; Bangkok Yai; Bung Kum; Chatuchak; Chom Thong; Din Daeng; Don Muang; Dusit; Huai Khwang; Kannayao; Klong San; Klong Toey; Laksi; Lat Krabang; Lat Phrao; Min Buri; Nong Chok; Nong Khaem; Pathumwan; Phasicharoen; Phaya Thai; Phra Khanong; Phra Nakhon; Pomprap Sattruphai; Prawet; Rat Burana; Ratchathewi; Sai Mai; Saphan Sung; Samphanthawong; Sathon; Suan Luang; Taling Chan; Thon Buri; Thung Kru; Watthana; Yannawa

Bung Kan — Muang Bung Kan; Bung Khong Long; Pak Khat; Phon Charoen; Phon Phisai; Seka; Si Wilai; So Phisai

Buri Ram — Muang Buri Ram; Ban Dan; Ban Kruat; Chamni; Chaloem Phra Kiat; Huai Rat; Khaen Dong; Khu Mueang; Krasang; Lahan Sai; Lam Plai Mat; Na Pho; Nang Rong; Non Din Daeng; Non Suwan; Pakham; Phlapphla Chai; Prakhon Chai; Phutthaisong; Satuek

Chachoengsao — Muang Chachoengsao; Ban Pho; Bang Kla; Bang Nam Priao; Bang Pakong; Klong Khuean; Phanom Sarakham; Plaeng Yao; Ratchasan; Sanam Chai Khet; Tha Takiap

Chai Nat — Muang Chai Nat; Hankha; Manorum; Noen Kham; Nong Mamong; Sankhaburi; Sapphaya; Wat Sing

Chaiyaphum — Muang Chaiyaphum; Bamnet Narong; Ban Khwao; Ban Thaen; Chatturat; Kaeng Khro; Kaset Sombun; Khon San; Khon Sawan; Nong Bua Daeng; Nong Bua Rawe; Phakdi Chumphon; Phu Khiao; Sap Yai; Thep Sathit

Chanthaburi — Muang Chanthaburi; Kaeng Hang Maeo; Khao Khitchakut; Khlung; Laem Sing; Makham; Na Yai Am; Pong Nam Ron; Soi Dao; Tha Mai

Chiang Mai — Muang Chiang Mai; Chai Prakan; Chiang Dao; Chom Thong; Doi Lo; Doi Saket; Doi Tao; Fang; Galyani Vadhana; Hang Dong; Hot; Mae Ai; Mae Chaem; Mae On; Mae Rim; Mae Taeng; Mae Wang; Phrao; Samoeng; San Kamphaeng; San Pa Tong; San Sai; Saraphi; Wiang Haeng

Chiang Rai — Muang Chiang Rai; Chiang Khong; Chiang Saen; Doi Luang; Khun Tan; Mae Chan; Mae Fa Luang; Mae Lao; Mae Sai; Mae Suai; Pa Daet; Phan; Phaya Mengrai; Thoeng; Wiang Chaeng; Wiang Chiang Rung; Wiang Kaen; Wiang Pa Pao

Chon Buri — Muang Chon Buri; Ban Bueng; Bo Thong; Bang Lamung; Koh Chan; Koh Sichang; Nong Yai; Phan Thong; Phanat Nikhom; Sattahip; Si Racha

Chumphon — Muang Chumphon; Lamae; Pathio; Phato; Sawi; Tha Sae; Thung Tako

Kalasin — Muang Kalasin; Don Chan; Huai Mek; Huai Phueng; Kamalasai; Khao Wong; Khong Chai; Kuchinarai; Na Mon; Na Khu; Nong Kung Si; Rong Kham; Sahatsakhan; Sam Chai; Somdet; Tha Khantho; Yang Talat

Kamphaeng Phet — Muang Kamphaeng Phet; Bueng Samakkhi; Khanu Woralaksaburi; Klong Khlung; Klong Lan; Kosamphi Nakhon; Lan Krabue; Pang Sila Thong; Phran Kratai; Sai Thong Watthana; Trai Ngam

Kanchanaburi — Muang Kanchanaburi; Bo Phloi; Dan Makham Tia; Huai Krachao; Lao Khwan; Nong Prue; Phanom Thuan; Sai Yok; Sangkhla Buri; Si Sawat; Tha Maka; Tha Muang; Thong Pha Phum

Khon Kaen — Muang Khon Kaen; Ban Fang; Ban Haet; Ban Phai; Chonnabot; Chum Phae; Khao Suan Kwang; Kranuan; Manchakhiri; Nam Phong; Non Sila; Nong Na Kham; Nong Ruea; Nong Song Hong; Phu Pha Man; Phu Wiang; Pueai Noi; Sam Sung; Si Chomphu; Ubolratana; Waeng Noi; Waeng Yai

Krabi — Muang Krabi; Ao Luk; Khao Phanom; Klong Thom; Koh Lanta; Lam Thap; Nuea Klong; Plai Phraya

Lampang — Muang Lampang; Chae Hom; Hang Chat; Koh Kha; Mae Mo; Mae Phrik; Mae Tha; Mueang Pan; Ngao; Soem Ngam; Sop Prap; Thoen; Wang Nuea

Lamphun — Muang Lamphun; Ban Hong; Ban Thi; Mae Tha; Pa Sang; Thung Hua Chang; Wiang Nong Long

Loei — Muang Loei; Chiang Khan; Dan Sai; Erawan; Nong Hin; Na Duang; Na Haeo; Pak Chom; Pha Khao; Phu Kradueng; Phu Luang; Phu Ruea; Tha Li; Wang Saphung

Lop Buri — Muang Lop Buri; Ban Mi; Chai Badan; Khok Charoen; Khok Samrong; Lam Sonthi; Nong Muang; Phatthana Nikhom; Tha Luang; Tha Wung

Mae Hong Son — Muang Mae Hong Son; Khun Yuam; Mae La Noi; Mae Sariang; Pai; Pang Mapha; Sop Moei

Maha Sarakham — Muang Maha Sarakham; Borabue; Chiang Kuan; Chuen Chom; Kae Dam; Kantharawichai; Kosum Phisai; Kut Rang; Na Chueak; Na Dun; Phayakkhaphum Phisai; Wapi Pathum

Mukdahan — Muang Mukdahan; Dong Luang; Khamcha-i; Nong Sung; Wan Yai

Nakhon Nayok — Muang Nakhon Nayok; Ban Na; Ongkharak; Pak Phli

Nakhon Pathom — Muang Nakhon Pathom; Bang Len; Don Tum; Kamphaeng Saen; Nakhon Chai Si; Phutthamonthon; Sam Phran

Nakhon Phanom — Muang Nakhon Phanom; Ban Phaeng; Na Kae; Na Thom; Na Wa; Pla Pak; Phon Sawan; Renu Nakhon; Si Songkhram; Tha Uthen; That Phanom

Nakhon Ratchasima — Muang Nakhon Ratchasima; Ban Lai; Bua Lai; Bua Yai; Chakkarat; Chaloem Phra Kiat; Chok Chai; Chum Phuang; Dan Khun Thot; Huai Thalaeng; Kaeng Sanam Nang; Kham Sakaesaeng; Kham Thale So; Khon Buri; Mueang Yang; Non Daeng; Non Thai; Non Sung; Nong Bun Mak; Pak Chong; Pak Thong Chai; Phimai; Phra Thong Kham; Prathai; Sida; Sikhio; Soeng Sang; Sung Noen; Thepharak; Wang Nam Khiao

Nakhon Sawan — Muang Nakhon Sawan; Banphot Phisai; Chum Ta Bong; Chum Saeng; Kao Liao; Krok Phra; Lat Yao; Mae Wong; Nong Bua; Phaisali; Phayuha Khiri; Tak Fa; Takhli

Nakhon Si Thammarat — Muang Nakhon Si Thammarat; Bang Khan; Cha-uat; Chaloem Phra Kiat; Chang Klang; Chian Yai; Chulabhorn; Hua Sai; Khanom; Lan Saka; Na Bon; Nopphitam; Pak Phanang; Phipun; Phrom Khiri; Ron Phibun; Sichon; Tha Sala; Thung Song; Thung Yai

Nan — Muang Nan; Ban Luang; Bo Kluea; Chaloem Phra Kiat; Chiang Klang; Mae Charim; Na Noi; Na Muen; Phu Phiang; Pua; Santi Suk; Song Khwae; Tha Wang Pha; Thung Chang; Wiang Sa

Narathiwat — Muang Narathiwat; Bacho; Chanae; Cho-airong; Ra-ngae; Rueso; Si Sakhon; Sukhirin; Su-ngai Kolok; Su-ngai Padi; Tak Bai; Waeng; Yi-ngo

Nong Bua Lam Phu — Muang Nong Bua Lam Phu; Na Klang; Na Wang; Non Sang; Si Bun Rueang; Suwannakhuha

Nong Khai — Muang Nong Khai; Fao Rai; Pho Tak; Phon Phisai; Rattanawapi; Sa Khrai; Sangkhom; Si Chiang Mai; Tha Bo

Nonthaburi — Muang Nonthaburi; Bang Bua Thong; Bang Kruai; Bang Yai; Pak Kret; Sai Noi

Pathum Thani — Muang Pathum Thani; Klong Luang; Lam Luk Ka; Lat Lum Kaeo; Nong Suea; Sam Khok; Thanyaburi

Pattani — Muang Pattani; Kapho; Khok Pho; Mae Lan; Mai Kaen; Mayo; Nong Chik; Panare; Sai Buri; Thung Yang Daeng; Yarang; Yaring

Phangnga — Muang Phangnga; Kapong; Khura Buri; Koh Yao; Thap Put; Thai Mueang; Takua Pa; Takua Thung

Phatthalung — Muang Phatthalung; Bang Kaeo; Khao Chaison; Khuan Khanun; Kong Ra; Pa Bon; Pa Phayom; Pak Phayun; Srinagarindra; Tamot

Phayao — Muang Phayao; Chiang Kham; Chiang Muan; Chun; Dok Khamtai; Mae Chai; Phu Kamyao; Phu Sang; Pong

Phetchabun — Muang Phetchabun; Bueng Sam Phan; Chon Daen; Khao Kho; Lom Kao; Lom Sak; Nam Nao; Nong Phai; Si Thep; Wang Pong

Phetchaburi — Muang Phetchaburi; Ban Laem; Ban Lat; Cha-am; Kaeng Krachan; Khao Yoi; Nong Ya Plong; Tha Yang

Phichit — Muang Phichit; Bueng Na Rang; Dong Charoen; Pho Prathap Chang; Pho Thale; Sak Lek; Sam Ngam; Taphan Hin; Thap Khlo; Wachirabarami; Wang Sai Phun

Phitsanulok — Muang Phitsanulok; Bang Krathum; Bang Rakam; Chat Trakan; Nakhon Thai; Noen Maprang; Phrom Phiram; Wang Thong; Wat Bot

Phrae — Muang Phrae; Den Chai; Long; Nong Muang Khai; Rong Kwang; Song; Sung Men; Wang Chin

Phuket — Muang Phuket; Kathu; Thalang

Prachin Buri — Muang Prachin Buri; Ban Sang; Kabin Buri; Na Di; Prachantakham; Si Maha Phot; Si Mahosot

Prachuap Khiri Khan — Muang Prachuap Khiri Khan; Bang Saphan; Bang Saphan Noi; Hua Hin; Kui Buri; Pran Buri; Sam Roi Yot; Thap Sakae

Ranong — Muang Ranong; Kapoe; Kra Buri; La-un; Suk Samran

Ratchaburi — Muang Ratchaburi; Ban Kha; Ban Pong; Bang Phae; Chom Bueng; Damnoen Saduak; Pak Tho; Photharam; Suan Phueng; Wat Phleng

Rayong — Muang Rayong; Ban Chang; Ban Khai; Khao Chamao; Klaeng; Nikhom Phatthana; Pluak Daeng; Wang Chan

Roi Et — Muang Roi Et; At Samat; Chang Han; Chaturaphak Phiman; Chiang Khwan; Kaset Wisai; Moei Wadi; Nong Hi; Nong Phok; Pathum Rat; Phanom Phrai; Pho Chai; Phon Sai; Phon Thong; Selaphum; Si Somdet; Suwannaphum; Thawat Buri; Thung Khao Luang

Sa Kaeo — Muang Sa Kaeo; Aranyaprathet; Khao Chakan; Klong Hat; Khok Sung; Ta Phraya; Wang Nam Yen; Wang Sombun; Watthana Nakhon

Sakon Nakhon — Muang Sakon Nakhon; Akat Amnuai; Ban Muang; Charoen Sin; Kham Ta Kla; Khok Si Suphan; Kusuman; Kut Bak; Nikhom Nam Un; Phang Khon; Phanna Nikhom; Phon Na Kaeo; Phu Phan; Sawang Daen Din; Song Dao; Tao Ngoi; Wanon Niwat

Samut Prakan — Muang Samut Prakan; Bang Bo; Bang Phli; Bang Sao Thong; Phra Samut Chedi; Phra Pradaeng

Samut Sakhon — Muang Samut Sakhon; Ban Phaeo; Krathum Baen

Samut Songkhram — Muang Samut Songkhram; Amphawa; Bang Khonthi

Saraburi — Muang Saraburi; Ban Mo; Don Phut; Kaeng Khoi; Muak Lek; Nong Don; Nong Khae; Nong Saeng; Phra Phutthabat; Sao Hai; Wang Muang; Wihan Daeng

Satun — Muang Satun; Khuan Don; Khuan Kalong; La-ngu; Manang; Tha Phae; Thung Wa

Sing Buri — Muang Sing Buri; Bang Rachan; In Buri; Khai Bang Rachan; Phrom Buri; Tha Chang

Si Sa Ket — Muang Si Sa Ket; Benchalak; Bueng Bun; Huai Thap Than; Kantharalak; Kanthararom; Khukhan; Khun Han; Mueang Chan; Nam Kliang; Non Khun; Phayu; Pho Si Suwan; Phrai Bueng; Phu Sing; Prang Ku; Rasi Salai; Si Rattana; Sila Lat; Uthumphon Phisai; Wang Hin; Yang Chum Noi

Songkhla — Muang Songkhla; Bang Klam; Chana; Hat Yai; Klong Hoi Khong; Khuha Sawan; Na Mom; Na Thawi; Ranot; Rattaphum; Saba Yoi; Sadao; Sathing Phra; Singhanakhon; Thepha

Sukhothai — Muang Sukhothai; Ban Dan Lan Hoi; Khiri Mat; Kong Krailat; Sawankhalok; Si Nakhon; Si Samrong; Si Satchanalai; Thung Saliam

Suphan Buri — Muang Suphan Buri; Bang Pla Ma; Dan Chang; Doem Bang Nang Buat; Nong Ya Sai; Sam Chuk; Song Phi Nong; U Thong

Surat Thani — Muang Surat Thani; Ban Na Doem; Ban Na San; Ban Takhun; Chaiya; Chai Buri; Don Sak; Kanchanadit; Khian Sa; Khiri Rat Nikhom; Koh Pha-ngan; Koh Samui; Phanom; Phrasaeng; Phunphin; Tha Chang; Tha Chana; Vibhavadi; Wiang Sa

Surin — Muang Surin; Buachet; Chom Phra; Chumphon Buri; Kap Choeng; Khwao Sinarin; Non Narai; Phanom Dong Rak; Prasat; Rattanaburi; Samrong Thap; Sangkha; Sikhoraphum; Si Narong; Tha Tum

Tak — Muang Tak; Ban Tak; Mae Ramat; Mae Sot; Phop Phra; Sam Ngao; Tha Song Yang; Wang Chao; Umphang

Trang — Muang Trang; Na Yong; Hat Samran; Huai Yot; Kantang; Palian; Ratsada; Sikao; Wang Wiset; Yan Ta Khao

Trat — Muang Trat; Bo Rai; Khao Saming; Klong Yai; Koh Chang; Koh Kut; Laem Ngop

Ubon Ratchathani — Muang Ubon Ratchathani; Buntharik; Det Udom; Don Mot Daeng; Khemarat; Khong Chiam; Khuang Nai; Kut Khaopun; Lao Sue Kok; Muang Samsip; Na Chaluai; Na Tan; Na Yia; Nam Khun; Nam Yuen; Phibun Mangsahan; Pho Sai; Samrong; Sawang Wirawong; Si Muang Mai; Sirinthorn; Tan Sum; Trakan Phuetphon; Thung Si Udom; Warin Chamrap

Udon Thani — Muang Udon Thani; Ban Dung; Ban Phue; Chaiwan; Ku Kaeo; Kumphawapi; Kut Chap; Nam Som; Na Yoong; Non Sa-at; Nong Han; Nong Sang; Nong Wua So; Phibun Rak; Phen; Prachak; Sang Khom; Si That; Thung Fon; Wang Sam Mo

Uthai Thani — Muang Uthai Thani; Ban Rai; Huai Khot; Lan Sak; Nong Chang; Nong Khayang; Sawang Arom; Thap Than

Uttaradit — Muang Uttaradit; Ban Khok; Fak Tha; Laplae; Nam Pat; Phichai; Tha Pla; Thong Saen Khan; Tron

Yala — Muang Yala; Bannang Sata; Betong; Kabang; Krong Pinang; Raman; Than To; Yaha

Yasothon — Muang Yasothon; Kham Khuean Kaeo; Kho Wang; Kut Chum; Loeng Nok Tha; Maha Chana Chai; Pa Tio; Sai Mun; Thai Charoen

ORGANISATIONS

Abu Sayyaf — House form.

al-Nusra Front — House form.

al-Qaeda — House form.

al-Qaeda in the Arabian Peninsula — Aqap after first reference.

al-Shebab — House form.

Ba'ath Party — House form.

Hezbollah — House form.

Houthis — House form.

The Islamic State — The IS after first reference. Do not use Isil, Isis or Daesh unless in quotes.

Jamaat-ul-Ahrar — House form.

Labor Party — Australia — no "u".

Malaysia Airlines — Not MalaysiaN.

Medecins Sans Frontieres — Not Doctors Without Borders.

Moro Islamic Liberation Front — MILF after first reference. Exception to the lower-case-acronym-said-as-word rule; avoids slang collision.

Pavena Foundation — Not Paveena. The founder Pavena Hongsakul is spelled the same way.

sharia law — Lower case.

Shia — Not Shi'ite or Shiite.

Yezidis — House form.

Fifa — Never FIFA, eg "2026 Fifa World Cup".

VOCABULARY & SPELLING

Words with BKP-specific ruling, common UK/US traps, and recurring errors. General British English usage is assumed; only divergent items listed.

NUMBERS AND SYMBOLS

2D, 3D, 4D — No hyphen.

7-Eleven — Use exact form; not 7-11.

9/11 — Use "Sept 11" except in quotes.

UK VS US TRAPS

bashed — Use assaulted.

bill — Banknote for cash.

cellphone — Mobile phone.

check — Cheque for money.

chips — Crisps for bags; chips/fries for hot food.

coach — Economy class.

drugstore — Pharmacy.

fall — Autumn.

football — Football is for soccer; specify gridiron or American where needed.

garage — Repairs or storage only — petrol station for fuel.

gas — Petrol, diesel or fuel.

pants — Trousers.

rubber — Eraser.

sneakers — Trainers.

Us Forms Acceptable — apartment; ATM; elevator; internship; public holiday; capsicum

VOCABULARY RULINGS

accede — Not ascend. Accede to the throne; accession not ascension.

AirAsia — One word; Asia capped.

antivenene — Not antivenom.

Asia-Pacific — Hyphenated.

average — Not a synonym for poor.

banzai vs bonsai — Banzai = hooray; bonsai = miniature trees.

Blu-ray — Trademark; cap B, hyphen, lower r.

capital of — Bangkok IS the capital. Do not write "the Thai capital of Bangkok".

Chatichai Choonhavan — BKP form for the former prime minister (d.1998) — NOT Chatchai Choonahavan (trap observed in filed PostBag copy, July 2026). Gen retained on all references (military rank, deceased). Relay-verified against bangkokpost.com usage, 27 May, 2026.

collide — Two cars collided; vehicles hit (not collide with) stationary objects.

comprising vs including — Comprising = full list; including = partial list.

completely destroyed — Tautology — use destroyed.

czar — Use tsar (exception — "crime czar").

decimate — Means heavy casualties, not "almost destroy".

defuse vs diffuse — Defuse a bomb; diffuse means to spread.

dhamma — Not dharma. (Karma is karma, not khamma.)

elicit vs illicit — Elicit = draw out; illicit = illegal.

ensure vs insure — Ensure = make certain; insure = insurance.

farther vs further — Farther = physical distance; further = abstract.

fewer than vs less than — Fewer for countable numbers; less for sizes/quantities.

flaunt vs flout — Flaunt = show off; flout = treat with contempt.

Formula 1 — Cap F, numeral 1. Abbreviate to F1.

future tense in news — Avoid. Use past-tense-as-future construction — "they were to meet on Friday", not "they will meet on Friday". Applies to events scheduled after the copy was filed but before publication.

historic vs historical — Historic = part of history; historical = concerning history.

imply vs infer — Imply = suggest; infer = deduce.

knots — A measure of speed, not distance. Do not say "knots per hour".

literally — Do not use figuratively.

media — Singular.

percent — Use %.

police — Not a countable noun. Use "police officers", not "five police".

protest — Specify if for or against something.

refute — Means disprove, not deny.

regime vs regimen — Regime = government; regimen = diet/exercise.

serial vs series — Serial = continuous plot; series = unrelated stories.

swat vs swot — Swat flies; swot for an exam.

Thai prefix — Superfluous in most cases ("the Thai government"). Strip unless differentiating.

Thailand time — Use only if event crosses calendar days. Never "Bangkok time" — one zone.

that vs which — That = definitive (no comma); which = descriptive (comma).

tortuous vs torturous — Tortuous = winding; torturous = excruciating.

transpire — Means leak out, not occur or happen.

Twitter / tweet — Twitter upper; tweet lower.

urban vs urbane — Urban = city; urbane = sophisticated.

versus / vs — Full in body text; "vs" in headlines and sports.

virus variant names — Cap the variant name (Delta variant, Omicron variant). Applies to Greek-letter and place-name variant designations alike.

weather — High/low temps (33C); kph for wind speeds.

where — Often misused for when or in which.

whether — Not "whether or not" if meaning "if".

whilst, amongst, amidst — Drop the -st (while, among, amid).

whisky vs whiskey — Whisky = Scotch; whiskey = American/Irish.

who vs whom — Who = he/she/they; whom = him/her/them.

widow — "Widow of the late" is tautology.

Xmas — Banned; use Christmas.